

The microtype package

Subliminal refinements towards typographical perfection

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<https://github.com/schlicht/microtype>

The microtype package provides a $\text{\LaTeX}$ interface to the micro-typographic extensions that were introduced by $\text{pdf\TeX}$ and some of which have since also propagated to $\text{Lua\TeX}$ and $\text{X\TeX}$: most prominently, character protrusion and font expansion, furthermore the adjustment of interword spacing and additional kerning, as well as hyphenatable letterspacing (tracking) and the possibility to disable all or selected ligatures. These features may be applied to customisable sets of fonts, and all micro-typographic aspects of the fonts can be configured in a straight-forward and flexible way. Settings for various fonts are provided.

Note that character protrusion requires $\text{pdf\TeX}$ (version 0.14f or later), $\text{Lua\TeX}$, or $\text{X\TeX}$ (at least version 0.9997). Font expansion works with $\text{pdf\TeX}$ (version 1.20 for automatic expansion) or $\text{Lua\TeX}$. The package will by default enable protrusion and expansion if they can safely be assumed to work. Disabling ligatures requires $\text{pdf\TeX}$ (≥ 1.30) or $\text{Lua\TeX}$, while the adjustment of interword spacing and of kerning only works with $\text{pdf\TeX}$ (≥ 1.40). Letterspacing is available with $\text{pdf\TeX}$ (≥ 1.40), $\text{Lua\TeX}$ (≥ 0.62) or $\text{X\TeX}$.

The alternative package `letterspace`, which also works with plain $\text{\TeX}$, provides the user commands for letterspacing only, omitting support for all other extensions (see section 7).

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